MILITARY SPECIFICATION

ERYTHROMYCIN TABLETS

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers Erythromycin Tablets.

1.2 Classification. The tablets covered by this specification shall be the following sizes (see 6.2):

Size 1 - Bottle of 40s
Size 2 - Bottle of 100s
Size 3 - Individually sealed, 100s

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposals, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

SPECIFICATIONS

Federal

PPP-C-186	Containers, Packaging and Packing for Drugs, Chemicals, and Pharmaceuticals (see 6.3).

STANDARDS

Federal

FED-STD-140	Tablets (for Medicinal Purposes).

FSC 6505

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Military

MIL-STD-105	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129	Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of specifications and standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposals shall apply.

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH, EDUCATION, AND WELFARE, FOOD AND DRUG ADMINISTRATION

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Food and Drug Administration, Washington, DC 20204.)

U. S. PHARMACOPEIAL CONVENTION, INC.

The United States Pharmacopeia.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Mack Publishing Company, Easton, PA 18042.)

National Formulary.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Mack Publishing Company, Easton, PA 18042.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. Shall be Erythromycin Tablets and shall be in accordance with all applicable requirements of FED-STD-140, and as specified herein.

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S2. Classification. Shall be in accordance with the requirements of classification (a) or (b), as follows:

(a) - Shall be type I, class 2, style B, grade 1.

(b) - Shall be type I.

S5.2 The following is added to this paragraph:

Shall be tablets containing 250 mg of Erythromycin, within the designated assay limits for the tablets.

The tablets shall assay to contain not less than 90.0 percent and not more than 120.0 percent of the required amount of Erythromycin.

The Erythromycin used in the tablets shall be present in the form of erythromycin base or a suitable salt or ester of erythromycin which is recognized in the U.S.P. XVII (which was official from 1 September 1965, to 31 August 1970), except for Erythromycin (base) and Erythromycin Stearate which shall comply with current U.S.P. NOTE: Erythromycin Estolate shall not be used in the preparation of the tablets.

Tablets made using erythromycin base shall be enteric-coated (Classification S2(a) above).

Tablets made using a suitable salt or ester of erythromycin, (except estolate) shall be such that the therapeutic effect is not lost when the tablets disintegrate in the portion of the intestinal tract superior to the small intestine (Classification S2(b) above).

The tablets shall comply with the applicable regulations of the Federal Food and Drug Administration concerning certification of Antibiotics and Antibiotic-containing Drugs and each lot shall be certified by the F.D.A.

S6.4.9.1 Disintegration. The disintegration time for tablets made using erythromycin base shall be run in accordance with the U.S.P. method for "Enteric-Coated Tablets". No tablet shall disintegrate in the simulated gastric fluid, T.S. (U.S.P.), proceed using the simulated intestinal fluid, T.S. (U.S.P.). The tablets shall disintegrate within 30 minutes in the simulated intestinal fluid, T.S. (U.S.P.). Thus, the total disintegration time shall not exceed 1-1/2 hours.

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Tablets made using a suitable salt or ester of Erythromycin, (except estolate) shall be tested by the U.S.P. procedure applicable to "Plain Coated Tablets". The disintegration time shall be one that is acceptable to the Food and Drug Administration; however, disintegration time shall not exceed 1-1/2 hours.

3.2 Expiration dating period. The expiration dating period for sizes 1 and 2 shall be 60 months and the expiration dating period for size 3 shall be not less than 24 months.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Supplier responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government, upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and, (i) as to any expiration dated item, for the expiration dating period (potency period) specified by the contractor for such item, or such longer period as may be required by regulation of any federal agency; or (ii) as to non-dated items, for not less than 3 years after delivery of the items to the Government.

4.1.2 No company supplying any ingredient(s) to the contractor will be considered an acceptable facility for the performance of any inspection requirements specified herein.

4.2 Sampling. The sampling as shown in FED-STD-140 shall be applicable.

4.3 Tests and examinations. Tests and examinations shall be performed to determine compliance with all requirements of this document and all referenced documents.

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4.4 Examination of preparation for delivery. An examination shall be made to determine whether the packaging, packing, and marking comply with the requirements of Section 5. Defects shall be scored as specified in Table I. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The sample unit shall be one container fully prepared for delivery. The lot shall be the number of containers offered for inspection at one time. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the acceptable quality level shall be 4.0 defects per hundred units. For labeling, the acceptance number shall be zero.

Table I. Examination of preparation for delivery

Examination	Defect
Containers	Not as specified.
Quantity	Quantity in interior packages and shipping containers not as specified.
Packaging and Packing Materials	Any component missing or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps, tape improperly applied, or containers distorted.
Markings	Omitted, incorrect, illegible, improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Preparation for delivery shall be in accordance with all applicable requirements of PPP-C-186, (see 6.3) and as specified herein.

5.2 Packaging. Packaging shall be Level A or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Unit of issue. One bottle containing forty (40) tablets of size 1 or one bottle containing one hundred (100) tablets of size 2 or one box containing one hundred (100) individually sealed tablets as specified, constitutes one unit of issue.

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5.2.2 Level A.

5.2.2.1 Immediate containers. Shall be a commercially available immediate container for sizes 1 and 2. Size 3 shall be individually sealed for unit dose use, in commercially available blister or strip packaging. Containers shall be considered acceptable to the Food and Drug Administration (FDA) for the product contained therein and shall be of such compatibility that neither the contents nor the container are altered in any way by each other. For size 1, a child-proof safety closure shall be supplied.

5.2.2.2 Unit package. At the option of the contractor, sizes 1, and 2 tablets may be packaged as specified in 5.2.5 of PPP-C-186. Size 3 tablets shall be packaged as specified in 5.2.5 of PPP-C-186.

5.2.2.3 Intermediate package. Twelve (12) units of size 1 and size 2 shall be packaged as specified in 5.2.7.1 of PPP-C-186. For size 3, ten (10) units shall be packaged as specified in 5.2.7.1 of PPP-C-186.

5.2.3 Level C. Units shall be packaged in standard commercial containers of the size and kind commonly used, which will afford the degree of protection required for shipment and use of the product for its intended purpose.

5.3 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.3.1 Level A. One hundred forty-four (144) units of size 1 or 2, or one hundred (100) units of size 3 shall be packed in an exterior container as specified in 5.4.4 of PPP-C-186.

5.3.2 Level B. One hundred forty-four (144) units of size 1 or 2, or one hundred (100) units of size 3 shall be packed as specified in 5.4.3.1.1 of PPP-C-186.

5.3.3 Level C. The subject commodity shall be packed in substantial commercial containers of the type, size, and kind commonly used for the purpose, so constructed as to insure acceptance and safe delivery by common or other carriers, at the lowest rate, to point of delivery called for in the contract or purchase order.

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5.4 Marking.

5.4.1 Labeling. Labeling shall be in accordance with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, and shall include the information required below.

5.4.1.1 Size 2 and 3.

5.4.1.1.1 Immediate container. Each immediate container label shall bear the following information:

(a) label information in accordance with commercial practice.

(b) the expiration date.

5.4.1.2 Size 1.

5.4.1.2.1 Immediate container. The label of the immediate container shall be a tri-part label consisting of the following:

(a) a tab portion which shall remain attached to the immediate container. This portion shall bear:

(a) the National Drug Code (NDC)
(b) the lot or control number
(c) the expiration date
NOTE: Other label information may be included.

(2) a tear-off portion adjacent to the tab portion, or at the extreme end of the label bearing the following:

(a) the National Drug Code (NDC)
(b) the lot or control number
(c) the expiration date

No other labeling shall appear thereon.
This portion shall be easily removed for attachment to a prescription.

(3) the principle portion connected to the tear-off and/or the tab portion shall bear the following:

(a) the National Stock Number (which shall not be preceded by any prefix).
(b) all other information required by the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act.

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This portion shall also be easily removed.

Label adhesion test shall not apply to any portion of the tri-part label.

5.4.1.3 Unit package. Each unit package shall bear the following:

(a) labeling information in accordance with commercial practice.

(b) the national stock number.

(c) extended potency lines.

NOTES:

(1) the national stock number shall not be preceded by any prefix.
(2) Strip labeling may be used.
(3) Label adhesion test shall not apply.
(4) For sizes 1 and 2. If a unit package is not supplied, the national stock number and extended potency lines shall appear on the immediate container label.

5.4.2 Intermediate package. Intermediate package shall be marked as specified in 5.5.3 of PPP-C-186. Type II Shelf life markings as specified in MIL-STD-129 shall be shown. Marking shall include the legend: "STORE AT CONTROLLED ROOM TEMPERATURE (59° - 86°F.)".

5.4.3 Exterior container. Exterior container shall be marked as specified in 5.5.4 of PPP-C-186. Type II shelf life marking as specified in MIL-STD-129 shall be shown. Marking shall include the legend: "STORE AT CONTROLLED ROOM TEMPERATURE (59° - 86°F.)".

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6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.
(b) the National Stock Number.
(c) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (See 5.2 and 5.3).

6.2 This specification covers the following item(s):

National Stock No.	Item Identification
6505-00-149-0119	ERYTHROMYCIN TABLETS, 0.25 Gram, 40s
6505-00-149-0204	ERYTHROMYCIN TABLETS, 0.25 Gram, Individually Sealed, 100s
6505-00-662-9790	ERYTHROMYCIN TABLETS, 0.25 Gram, 100s

6.3 All references to PPP-C-186 refer to Interim Federal Specification PPP-C-00186B which is mandatory for use until superseded by a revision.

6.4 This specification does not cover all types, classes, grades, or sizes of the commodity indicated by the title of this specification, or those which are commercially available, but is intended to cover the types which are normally procured to meet Military requirements.

Custodians:
Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing activity:
Defense Supply Agency - DM

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OMB Approval
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DOCUMENT IDENTIFIER AND TITLE
MIL-E-37256 ERYTHROMYCIN TABLETS

NAME OF ORGANIZATION AND ADDRESS

CONTRACT NUMBER

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A
☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE DOCUMENT CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?
   A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

   B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

2. COMMENTS ON ANY DOCUMENT REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE DOCUMENT RESTRICTIVE?
   ☐ YES ☐ NO *(If "Yes", in what way?)*

4. REMARKS

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and address - Optional)*

TELEPHONE NO.

DATE

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